Marriage-Based Green Card (I-130 / I-485) Interview

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Many marriage-based adjustment cases include an interview where a USCIS officer confirms your identity, eligibility and that the marriage is genuine (bona fide).

Key facts from official sources

- A U.S. citizen or permanent resident files Form I-130 to establish the family relationship; the relative in the U.S. may file Form I-485 to adjust status. [Source 2]
- Form I-485 is the application to register permanent residence or adjust status. [Source 1]
- Bring the documents listed on your interview notice; USCIS decides what it needs to see in each case. [Source 1]

Commonly reported practice questions

Commonly reported practice questions: these are general topics people report being asked about. They are NOT an official USCIS or Department of State list. Officers may ask anything related to your case. Answer truthfully and consistently with your forms.

- How and where you met, and how the relationship developed.
- Details of the wedding or ceremony and who attended.
- Daily life: who lives in the home, routines, work schedules.
- Shared finances, lease or mortgage, insurance and bills.
- Each other's families, birthdays and future plans.
- Questions confirming answers on your I-130, I-485 and supporting forms.

Document checklist

Always follow the list on your own interview notice or embassy instructions first.

- ☐ Interview notice for both spouses
- ☐ Passports, IDs, and the beneficiary's I-94/entry records
- ☐ Original marriage certificate and any prior divorce/death records
- ☐ Birth certificates (with certified translations if not in English)
- ☐ Evidence of a shared life: joint lease/deed, bank statements, insurance, tax returns, photos over time
- ☐ Affidavit of support documents and recent tax records for the sponsor, as requested
- ☐ Medical exam (Form I-693) if requested on the notice

☐ Copies of everything you filed

Interview day tips

- Review your forms together, but answer in your own words; no memorized scripts.
- Saying 'I don't know' is better than guessing.
- Bring originals and copies, organized in the order of your notice.
- If the officer separates spouses for questions, stay calm; it is part of some interviews.

Stay organized

Keep your documents and deadlines in one place with PathwayUS, an organizing tool (not legal help): mypathwayusa.com/landing

Sources

1 USCIS: Form I-485: https://www.uscis.gov/i-485

2 USCIS: Form I-130: https://www.uscis.gov/i-130

3 USCIS: Filing Fees: https://www.uscis.gov/forms/filing-fees

Contact: pnsglobalIlc@gmail.com · Sources checked 2026-10-16. Practice questions are general and not official.